

A photo from Grandma's past

Family life · lesson 2

Saturday 3 October 2026



Your school work and app practice

What English did school set this week?

Show one question or paragraph that felt difficult.

Did you send the Family life chat and email in the app?

First try: a weekend in four sentences

Tell me about a real or invented weekend.
What happened first? What happened next?
Why did one thing happen?
What does your family usually do together?

Today's aim

Tell a clear past event.

Explain why it happened using evidence.

Write a friendly email about a family memory.

What might the photo show?

Look at the old photograph.

Who do you think took it?

What might Grandma say about that day?

Which detail could surprise Maya?

Words we can use

grow up keep in touch move away
remember share a photo ask first

Choose two phrases. Make one sentence about now and one about the past.

Maya and the old photograph

On Saturday, Maya visited Grandma with her cousin Leo. They wanted to sort old photographs before lunch. Grandma found a picture of herself with a bicycle outside a small shop.

“Was that your holiday bike?” Leo asked. Grandma laughed. “No. I rode it to school every day. My parents worked in that shop, and I helped there after class.”

The plan changes

Maya asked who took the picture. “My brother Paul did. He moved to England years ago, but we call each Sunday,” Grandma said.

Then rain started, so their picnic moved into the kitchen. Grandma suggested sending the photograph to Paul. Maya wanted to post it online. She asked Grandma first. Grandma preferred a private message to the family.

Find the evidence

1. Why was Leo's first idea wrong?
2. Why did the picnic move?
3. What do we know about Grandma and Paul now?
4. Did Maya post the photograph online?

Reason, result and intention

Reason: It started to rain.

Result: The picnic moved inside.

Grandma's wish: Send the photo to Paul.

What did Maya want to do first?

What did she do before sharing it?

Usually, now and last Saturday

Usually: Grandma and Paul call on Sundays.

Now: Maya is looking at a photograph.

Last Saturday: Grandma found an old picture.

Make three new sentences about this family.

Retell it without the text

Who was there?

What did they find?

What changed?

What did they decide about the photo?

A short break

Five minutes.

We start again with a message from Paul.

A message from Paul

Rory reads aloud twice.

First listen: How does Paul feel about the old photo?

A. Embarrassed B. Happy C. Angry

Listen again for details

Rory reads the same message a second time.

1. Where did Paul live when the photo was taken?
2. Why did Grandma reach school before Paul?
3. What does Paul want to do next Sunday?

Paul's message: what do we know?

What did Paul say about his own bicycle?

What did he thank Maya for?

Which detail from the reading is missing from Paul's message?

Plan an email to a friend

Your friend Alex asks: “What did you do with your family last weekend?”

Greeting → usual family activity → one past event → how you felt → friendly ending

Use a real or invented family.

Write your email

Write 120–150 words to Alex.

Include a usual activity and a different event from last weekend.

Use because and at least one other linking word.

Check one past verb and one usually sentence.

Feedback and a second try

Read your email once.

Choose one sentence you like.

Improve one sentence after Rory's feedback.

Keep the first version so we can see the change.

A new situation

At the park, Ben and his aunt planned a picnic. Dark clouds arrived. Ben showed her another place on his phone.

Tell the story in three past sentences.

Why did the plan change?

What could Ben ask his aunt?



Practice before next time

In Rory's English, finish or revise your Family life email.
Send answers to Rory and check the receipt.
Bring the next textbook pages if school has moved on.

Optional reserve: family links

Grandma's brother Paul is Maya's...?

Paul has a daughter, Sam. Who is Sam to Grandma?

Now invent two more relatives and explain the links.

Optional reserve: choose the tense

Every Sunday they ____ (call) Paul.

Last Saturday they ____ (find) a photograph.

Right now Maya ____ (write) to Alex.

Use all three ideas in a short story.

Optional reserve: another viewpoint

Speak as Grandma for one minute.

Why was the photograph special?

What did you want Maya to do?

What do you hope will happen on Sunday?

Optional reserve: reply to Paul

Write 60–80 words as Maya.

Thank Paul. Say what surprised you.

Suggest a time for Sunday's video call.

Ask one clear question about his photo.